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NOMURA SERVICES, INDIA CODING CONTEST PROBLEM STATEMENT



Kakushin INNOVATE N

Financial Literacy & Agentic AI Hackathon

ArthSaathi – Your Digital Financial Companion

Financial Guardians – AI Agents for Financial Empowerment

In a nation where financial inclusion is transforming millions of lives, financial literacy remains the missing link between opportunity and prosperity. As India's economy surges forward with digital payments, investment platforms, and fintech innovations, a critical question emerges: Are we truly empowering people to make informed financial decisions, or merely digitizing their confusion?

Our country stands at a unique crossroads. While UPI transactions break records daily and stock market participation reaches new highs, millions still struggle with basic financial concepts – understanding credit scores, planning for retirement, distinguishing between insurance products, or avoiding predatory lending schemes. The gap between financial access and financial understanding has never been wider.



Look around – dedicated educators, NGOs, and community workers are already fighting financial illiteracy. From conducting workshops in local languages to counseling families on debt management, these financial warriors face challenges head-on. But they can't scale their impact alone.



Imagine if each person had a personal financial guide – available 24/7, speaking their language, understanding their context, and proactively helping them make better money decisions. These AI agents, when deployed thoughtfully, could create an unstoppable force for financial empowerment. Let's make it happen – for our communities, for financial inclusion, for our collective prosperity!

The time is now. The place is here. The force is you!

Background

Meet Priya

A 32-year-old school teacher in Thane earning ₹35,000 monthly. She wants to save for her daughter's education and plan for retirement, but feels overwhelmed by financial jargon. Every time she visits her bank, she's sold products she doesn't understand – from ULIPs to complex mutual funds. She tried reading articles online but found them either too technical or not relevant to her income level. Her WhatsApp is flooded with "investment tips" from unknown sources, and she doesn't know what's legitimate.

Priya dreams of having a trusted advisor who understands her goals, speaks Marathi, and can explain financial concepts in simple terms. Without structured financial education tailored to her life stage and income level, Priya makes decisions based on fear or peer pressure rather than understanding. She's missed out on employer benefits, paid unnecessary charges, and struggles to track where her money goes each month.

Meet Rajesh

A 24-year-old gig worker in Mumbai earning variable income through food delivery and freelancing. His income fluctuates between ₹15,000 to ₹40,000 monthly, making traditional budgeting impossible. He has no emergency fund, no health insurance, and often falls prey to instant loan apps with predatory interest rates.

Rajesh wants to learn about money management but doesn't know where to start. The financial advisors at banks tell him to "come back when you have ₹5 lakhs to invest." YouTube videos on financial planning seem designed for salaried professionals with regular income. He needs guidance on managing irregular cash flow, building small emergency savings, and avoiding debt traps – but in bite-sized, practical steps that fit his chaotic schedule.

Meet Kisan

A 45-year-old farmer in rural Karnataka cultivating 3 acres of land. His income is seasonal and weather-dependent, creating massive cash flow challenges. He takes informal loans at high interest rates during sowing season, often losing money to middlemen when selling his produce. He's heard about government schemes like PM-KISAN, crop insurance, and Kisan Credit Cards but finds the application processes confusing and intimidating.

Kisan struggles with basic financial planning – when to save, how much to set aside for the next season, whether to invest in better equipment or save for his children's education. He has questions about market prices, minimum support prices, and how to protect himself from crop failures, but has no one to ask. Most financial services aren't designed for agricultural income patterns, and he finds it difficult to access information in Kannada that's relevant to his farming context.

Meet Divya

A 28-year-old person with visual impairment working as a content writer from home in Pune. She earns ₹25,000 monthly but faces unique challenges in managing her finances. Most banking apps and financial platforms aren't screen-reader friendly, making even basic transactions stressful. She wants to learn about tax-saving instruments, understand her EPF statements, and start investing, but financial literacy content is rarely accessible to persons with disabilities.

Divya relies on family members to help with complex financial tasks, which compromises her financial independence and privacy. She wishes for financial tools that understand her specific needs – voice-based interactions, accessible interfaces, and guidance that doesn't assume she can see charts and graphs. She's eligible for government schemes for persons with disabilities but doesn't know how to access them or manage the benefits effectively.

Problem Statement

Your challenge is to develop an **Agentic AI-powered solution** that democratizes financial literacy and empowers individuals across diverse economic backgrounds, abilities, and contexts to make informed financial decisions.

Broad Questions to Explore:

- How might AI agents adapt to vastly different user contexts (income patterns, literacy levels, abilities, languages, life situations) to provide relevant financial guidance?
- What innovative approaches can make financial literacy accessible to underserved populations who are often excluded from traditional financial education?
- How can technology bridge the gap between financial access and financial understanding in a scalable, sustainable way?
- What role can AI play in building trust and confidence in financial decision-making for vulnerable populations?
- How do we ensure that AI solutions are inclusive, accessible, and work across different abilities, languages, and technological constraints?
- What mechanisms can drive sustained engagement with financial learning and encourage positive behavioral change?
- How might we measure real-world impact and ensure that solutions create tangible improvements in people's financial well-being?

We encourage you to think beyond these questions and explore novel approaches that address financial literacy challenges in ways we haven't imagined!



Possible Expected Outcomes

Note: The following are illustrative guidelines, not requirements. We encourage you to think creatively and propose innovative solutions that may go beyond or differ from these suggestions.

Core Considerations:

Accessibility & Inclusion:

- Solutions should consider diverse user groups including varying literacy levels, languages, physical abilities, and technological access
- Consider voice-first, text-based, visual, or multimodal approaches based on user needs
- Think about offline capabilities for low-connectivity areas

User Experience:

- How will your solution make financial literacy engaging and not overwhelming?
- What mechanisms will build trust with users who may be skeptical of technology or financial institutions?
- How will you personalize experiences to individual contexts and needs?

Impact & Sustainability:

- How will you track whether users are actually improving their financial decision-making?
- What engagement strategies will encourage long-term usage rather than one-time interactions?
- How can your solution scale to reach millions while maintaining quality?

Responsible AI:

- How will you ensure transparency about AI capabilities and limitations?
- What safeguards will protect vulnerable users from manipulation or harmful advice?
- How will you handle sensitive financial data responsibly?
- What mechanisms for human oversight or escalation will you include?

Technical Innovation:

- Consider creative uses of Agentic AI, multi-agent systems, or other emerging technologies
- Think about integration possibilities with existing financial ecosystems
- Explore novel interaction paradigms that go beyond traditional chatbots

Areas You Might Explore (Not Exhaustive):

- Personalized financial education and guidance systems
- Fraud prevention and scam awareness tools
- Tools for managing irregular or seasonal incomes
- Accessible financial interfaces for persons with disabilities
- Multilingual and culturally-relevant content generation
- Behavioral change mechanisms (gamification, nudges, social support)
- Impact measurement and outcome tracking
- Tools for educators/NGOs to scale their reach
- Financial planning for specific contexts (agriculture, gig economy, retirement, etc.)

The sky is the limit! We're looking for innovative thinking, not checkbox implementations.

Your solution has the potential to transform millions of lives by making financial literacy accessible, engaging, and actionable. We can't wait to see what you build!

Make your mark. Empower millions. Build the future of financial literacy!

Image Source Links:

- [1773904735557 \(500x281\)](#)
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